

items such as furniture, to appliances such as washing machines, ovens, and cars. Almost all the things that we buy are goods that have been manufactured in some way, whether it's by a large factory that mass-produces particular goods, or a small workshop making handcrafted, luxury items. In addition to the manufactured goods that we have in our homes, we need the houses themselves to live in. Buildings are also a kind of good, and are produced by the construction industries. In addition to providing housing, the construction industry also produces buildings for commercial use, such as factories, offices, hotels, railroad stations, and stores.



Making and doing

People are employed in different sectors of the economy, providing raw materials, producing manufactured goods, or offering services.

Service sector

While industries such as agriculture and mining provide raw materials, and manufacturing and construction industries produce tangible goods, there is a third sector of industry that does not make a tangible product—something that a buyer can physically own and keep. Instead, these businesses offer a service. Some services are closely connected with physical goods, for example, transportation companies that collect goods from a farmer or a factory and then deliver them to customers. There are also many different types of retail businesses, which buy goods from manufacturers and sell them to the general public through their stores. The service sector also includes